

12 Feb
2024

COMPANIES AND REGIONS

The proposal for a National Health Plan for the Country

BOOKMARK | ☆

FACEBOOK | f

TWITTER | t

In Italy, a National Health Plan has been absent since 2008. The main tool for the country's health planning, it has been abandoned in oblivion in favor of contractual instruments that are mainly responsible for the distribution of economic resources for health. More agile instruments, since their process does not require a passage through Parliament, but which, also for this reason, have not been able to replace the central role of the National Health Plan in its function of applying the constitutional mandate of "health protection" over the years. The results of the lack of planning are now further exacerbated by the hard blow inflicted by the pandemic, and put our health system at risk with profiles of non-sustainability of the National Health Service, lack of trained and specialized personnel in the most deficient disciplines, territorial non-homogeneity of access to care, and in short, lack of respect for the uniform provision of essential levels of care across the country.



In these sixteen years, the national scenario and health needs have changed profoundly. The demographic transition has generated an increasingly older population and increased the need for assistance not only in the health sector, but also in the social and socio-health sphere; climate change has worsened weather conditions and led to such significant environmental problems that the Constitution has modified its Article 9 by including the environment among the necessary protections also in view of future generations; geopolitical scenarios have changed the security of supply chains of goods now considered essential.

From the analysis of the over 70 indicators that make up the Health Proximity Index, the survey on the availability of health in the country that the Health, Well-being and Resilience Observatory of the Bruno Visentini Foundation annually carries out, an impact of the phenomena described emerges not only on the health component, but also on the individual, social and environmental dimension, bringing the Health Proximity Index to its historical minimum of 86 points for 2022, 14 points less than in 2010 and with a trend of further rapid worsening underway with 4 points less than the

previous year 2021.

The results of the research will be made public on the occasion of the presentation of the new Observatory Report "Connecting the dots: towards a national health plan" which will be held on the initiative of Senator Ylenia Zambito on February 22nd from 9.00 am in the Zuccari room of Palazzo Giustiniani of the Senate of the Republic.

"From the observation of the impact on health that, today more than ever, heterogeneous phenomena have, and not only of a health nature - says Duilio Carusi, Coordinator of the Observatory and Adjunct Professor at Luiss Business School - the need arises to rediscover a moment of general planning at a country level on health issues, starting from the National Health Plan and taking advantage of the delay accumulated in these last 16 years to broaden the scope of action of this instrument, arriving at describing a national health plan that involves all the actors capable in various ways of bringing health closer to the person".

© ALL RIGHTS RESERVED

[Privacy policy](#) | [Extended information on the use of cookies](#) | ISSN 2499-6599